

# Competitive Intelligence Report — Global Personal Finance Apps

Date: 2026-05-07 | Market: Global (US, EU, UK, AU, CA, SEA non-VN, LATAM) | Currency: USD only

## 1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — TOP 5 TAKEAWAYS

- My Money Went's \$4/mo Pro nằm ở 33rd percentile (value positioning)** — dưới Simplifi (\$5.99), trên Toshl (\$2.99). \$9/mo Business ở 41st percentile — competitive middle. Cả hai pricing hợp lý, không cần điều chỉnh ngay.
- White space rõ nhất: "Messaging-first + Personal/Business split" tại \$9/mo** — Không app nào combine Telegram bot + email parsing + P&L split dưới \$10/mo. YNAB/Monarch charge \$8-15/mo chỉ cho personal. QuickBooks Solopreneur \$20/mo không có personal finance. Gap này real.
- Messaging-first finance apps historically struggled** — Charlie shutdown, Cleo evolved away from Messenger sang native app. Telegram finance bot market fragmented (~\$5-20M TAM globally). Tuy nhiên, Telegram 1B MAU + zero dominant finance bot = early mover window. Key lesson: bot phải là CHANNEL, không phải toàn bộ product.
- Mint shutdown (3/2024, 3.6M users) tạo permanent fragmentation** — Không app nào capture >40% refugees. Monarch Money là primary beneficiary nhưng vẫn chưa dominant. Market vẫn đang settle — cơ hội cho new entrants với clear niche.
- 3 threats lớn nhất:** (a) Monarch Money Plus (\$199/yr) vừa thêm business tracking Q2 2026, (b) Cleo (\$300M+ ARR, 1.1M paying) có thể pivot vào personal/business split, (c) YNAB nếu thêm automation + email parsing sẽ capture power user segment. Tuy nhiên, cả 3 đều unlikely invest vào Telegram bot — đó là moat window.

## 2. APP DEEP DIVES

### A.1 — DIRECT COMPETITORS (Automated Personal Finance)

#### 2.1 YNAB (You Need A Budget)

##### METADATA

- Developer: YNAB Inc. (independent)
- Ra mắt: 2004 (desktop), 2015 (web/mobile relaunch)
- HQ: Lehi, Utah, US
- Markets: US, CA, UK, EU, AU (global web access)
- Rating: 4.8★ iOS (50k+ reviews) | 4.7★ Android (19k+ reviews)
- User base: 99.8k Trustpilot reviews; 92% report reduced financial stress [unverified exact MAU]
- Funding: Bootstrapped — no external funding
- Platforms: iOS, Android, Web, Apple Watch | No Telegram/Messenger/Discord

##### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: KHÔNG — chỉ 34-day free trial (không cần credit card)
- Paid: \$14.99/mo hoặc \$109/yr (\$9.08/mo) — 39% annual discount

- Lifetime: Không
- Family: Không riêng — 1 subscription, unlimited budget sharing
- Student: Free 1 year (với .edu email)
- Payment: Stripe, IAP (iOS/Android)

## CÁCH HOẠT ĐỘNG

- Onboarding: 30-60 phút (learning curve cao vì zero-based budgeting methodology)
- Transaction input: Plaid bank sync (auto) + manual entry
- Bank coverage: 12,000+ institutions via Plaid (US/CA/UK/EU/AU)
- Categorization: Rule-based + user-defined
- Reporting: Spending reports, net worth, age of money — KHÔNG custom reports
- Multi-currency: KHÔNG native — workaround qua plugins
- Personal vs Business: KHÔNG — single-purpose personal budgeting
- Notifications: Real-time sync alerts, overspending warnings
- AI: Không
- API/Zapier: Official API available

## STRENGTHS

1. Brand loyalty cực mạnh — "YNAB changed my life" culture, subreddit 800k+ members
2. Zero-based budgeting methodology = sticky retention (users invest time learning)
3. Bootstrapped = no VC pressure, sustainable business model
4. 34-day free trial không cần credit card — low friction entry
5. Student discount (1 year free) builds early habit

## WEAKNESSES (gaps My Money Went exploit)

1. **No automation beyond Plaid** — không email parsing, không SMS, không receipt OCR
2. **No multi-currency native** — power users phàn nàn liên tục trên r/ynab
3. **No personal vs business split** — solopreneurs phải dùng 2 budgets riêng
4. **Learning curve cao** — 30-60 phút onboarding vs My Money Went 2-15 phút
5. **\$109/yr expensive** — pricing backlash trên Reddit khi tăng từ \$99

## USER FEEDBACK

- r/ynab: "Steep learning curve + hands-on + price creep = locked into system that isn't working for me" [recurring theme]
- r/personalfinance: "YNAB is great if you commit, but I want something more automatic"
- Trustpilot: 4.6/5 average — complaints focus on sync delays, categorization friction

**POSITIONING:** "Give Every Dollar A Job" — zero-based budgeting methodology **TARGET:** Personal finance enthusiasts, debt-payoff focused, households

## 2.2 MONARCH MONEY

### METADATA

- Developer: Monarch Money Inc.
- Ra mắt: 2021
- HQ: San Francisco, CA, US
- Markets: US primary (expanding)
- Rating: 4.9★ iOS [unverified review count]
- User base: 30k+ Reddit community; primary Mint migration beneficiary
- Funding: [unverified] — likely VC-backed, no public round data

- Platforms: iOS, Android, Web | No Telegram/Messenger

## PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: Limited (view-only dashboard, no sync)
- Core: \$14.99/mo hoặc \$99.99/yr (\$8.33/mo) — 44% annual discount
- Plus: \$199/yr — business tracking, forecasting, estate planning (NEW Q2 2026)
- Trial: 7-day free
- Family: Unlimited household members included (no per-user fee)
- Lifetime: Không

## CÁCH HOẠT ĐỘNG

- Onboarding: ~30 phút (simpler than YNAB)
- Transaction input: Plaid bank sync + manual
- Bank coverage: 12,000+ via Plaid
- Categorization: ML auto-categorization (cannot be disabled — user complaint)
- Reporting: Dashboards, net worth, investment tracking, custom reports
- Multi-currency: Không native
- Personal vs Business: YES — Plus tier (\$199/yr) mới thêm Q2 2026
- Family: Unlimited couples/household sharing free
- AI: Auto-categorization ML, spending insights
- API: Không public

## STRENGTHS

1. Fastest-growing challenger — primary Mint migration destination
2. Couples/household sharing free (YNAB charges same, Copilot no sharing)
3. Investment + net worth tracking included
4. Modern UI, simpler than YNAB learning curve
5. Plus tier (\$199/yr) adds business tracking — first premium move

## WEAKNESSES

1. **Shorter free trial (7 days vs YNAB 34 days)** — higher conversion friction
2. **ML auto-categorization cannot be disabled** — power users frustrated
3. **\$199/yr Plus = expensive** for business features My Money Went offers at \$9/mo (\$108/yr)
4. **No email parsing, no SMS, no messaging bot**
5. **Relatively new brand** — less trust than YNAB

## USER FEEDBACK

- r/MonarchMoney: "Best Mint replacement" [dominant sentiment]
- r/personalfinance: "Switched from YNAB — simpler, cheaper yearly"
- ProductHunt: Strong launch reception [unverified exact score]

**POSITIONING:** "The modern way to manage your money" — comprehensive dashboard **TARGET:** Couples, households, Mint refugees, investment-aware consumers

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## 2.3 COPILOT MONEY

### METADATA

- Developer: Copilot Money Inc.
- Ra mắt: ~2020
- HQ: US

- Markets: US (Apple ecosystem only)
- Rating: Apple Design Award finalist
- Funding: [unverified — confidential]
- Platforms: iOS, iPad, Mac, Web (Dec 2025) | **NO ANDROID** | No Telegram

#### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: Không
- Paid: \$13/mo hoặc \$95/yr (\$7.92/mo) — 39% annual discount
- Trial: [unverified]
- Lifetime: Không

#### CÁCH HOẠT ĐỘNG

- Transaction input: Plaid bank sync + manual
- Categorization: AI-first
- Reporting: Beautiful native dashboards, investment tracking, crypto tracking
- Multi-currency: Không
- Personal vs Business: Không
- Family: Không sharing

#### STRENGTHS

1. Best-in-class design (Apple Design Award level)
2. AI-first categorization
3. Investment + crypto tracking
4. Native Apple ecosystem integration

#### WEAKNESSES

1. **NO ANDROID** — excludes 70% of global smartphone market
2. **No family sharing** — single user only
3. **No business features**
4. **No messaging/chat integration**
5. **Confidential metrics** — hard to assess traction

**POSITIONING:** Premium Apple-native finance dashboard **TARGET:** Apple power users, investors, design-conscious consumers

## 2.4 ROCKET MONEY (formerly Truebill)

#### METADATA

- Developer: Rocket Companies (parent of Rocket Mortgage)
- Ra mắt: 2015 (Truebill), rebranded 2022
- HQ: US
- Markets: US only
- User base: 10M+ total, 4.1M premium (end 2024); claimed \$2.5B savings
- Funding: Acquired by Rocket Companies
- Platforms: iOS, Android, Web

#### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: YES — subscription tracking, basic budgets
- Paid: \$6-12/mo (pay-what-you-think flex model) hoặc \$48/yr (\$4/mo)
- Trial: 7-day free

- Lifetime: Không
- Bill negotiation: Commission-based (40-60% of savings)

## CÁCH HOẠT ĐỘNG

- Transaction input: Plaid bank sync
- Categorization: Auto + manual
- Key feature: **Bill negotiation service** — Rocket Money contacts providers to lower bills
- Subscription management: Detect and cancel unwanted subscriptions
- Multi-currency: Không
- Personal vs Business: Không

## STRENGTHS

1. Largest user base (10M+) — network effects
2. Bill negotiation = unique value prop (saves \$180-400/yr average)
3. Subscription management as hook feature
4. Backed by Rocket Companies — stable
5. \$48/yr annual = competitive price point

## WEAKNESSES

1. **US-only** — no international expansion
2. **Requires Plaid bank link** — privacy barrier
3. **Limited budgeting depth** — not zero-based, not envelope
4. **Pay-what-you-think pricing confusing** — users unsure what to pay
5. **Bill negotiation commission eats into savings**

**POSITIONING:** "Save more, spend less" — subscription management + bill negotiation **TARGET:** Mass consumer, cost-conscious, subscription-heavy users

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## 2.5 POCKETGUARD

### METADATA

- Developer: PocketGuard Inc.
- HQ: US
- Rating: iOS varies 3.8-4.5 | Android similar variance
- User base: 500k+ downloads
- Platforms: iOS, Android, Web

### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: YES nhưng crippled — 2 accounts, 2 categories, 1 cash account
- Paid: \$12.99/mo hoặc \$74.99/yr (\$6.25/mo) — 52% annual discount
- **Lifetime: \$149.99** (only app with lifetime option in personal finance)
- Trial: 7-day free

## STRENGTHS

1. "In My Pocket" feature — instant safe-to-spend amount
2. Debt payoff planner
3. Dual aggregators (Plaid + Finicity = 18k institutions)
4. Only lifetime license option (\$149.99)

## WEAKNESSES

1. **#1 complaint: bank sync instability** — MFA loops, delays
2. **Aggressive price hikes** (2x increase 2023-2026)
3. **Free tier too crippled** — 2 accounts unusable
4. **Slow development velocity**
5. Trust damaged — Reddit users migrating to Monarch

**POSITIONING:** "See what's in your pocket" — safe-to-spend focus **TARGET:** Budget-curious consumers, debt-focused

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## 2.6 EMPOWER (formerly Personal Capital)

### METADATA

- Developer: Empower (parent company)
- Ra mắt: 2009 (Personal Capital)
- HQ: US
- User base: 19.5M+ (mostly workplace plans); \$2T AUM
- Platforms: iOS, Android, Web

### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: YES — unlimited account aggregation, net worth, investment tracking
- Paid: 0.49%-0.89% AUM advisory fees (\$100k+ minimum)
- No subscription tier

### STRENGTHS

1. Best-in-class FREE net worth + investment tracking
2. Retirement planning calculator
3. Fee analysis tool
4. Real estate integration

### WEAKNESSES

1. **Not a budgeter** — free tier is view-only aggregation
2. **\$100k minimum for advisory** — excludes 90% of users
3. **Not relevant to expense tracking or business P&L**

**POSITIONING:** Wealth management platform **TARGET:** High-net-worth wealth accumulators — NOT direct competitor to My Money Went

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## 2.7 QUICKEN SIMPLIFI

### METADATA

- Developer: Quicken Inc. (Intuit spinoff)
- HQ: US
- Markets: US, CA
- Rating: 4.4★ iOS | 4.3★ Android

### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: KHÔNG — 30-day money-back guarantee only
- Paid: \$5.99/mo hoặc \$35.88/yr (\$2.99/mo) — **LOWEST IN MARKET**
- Lifetime: Không

### STRENGTHS

1. **Lowest price point** (\$35.88/yr)
2. AI-generated Spending Plan
3. 24/7 support included
4. No ads

#### WEAKNESSES

1. No free tier
2. No investment tracking
3. Weaker Android experience
4. Lower satisfaction vs YNAB/Monarch

**POSITIONING:** "Simplified budgeting" — anti-YNAB (passive/automatic) **TARGET:** Busy professionals wanting hands-off tracking

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## 2.8 EVERYDOLLAR (Ramsey Solutions)

#### METADATA

- Developer: Ramsey Solutions
- HQ: Nashville, TN, US

#### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: YES — useful but NO bank sync (manual entry only)
- Premium: \$17.99/mo hoặc \$79.99/yr (\$6.67/mo) — 63% annual discount
- Trial: 14-day free

#### STRENGTHS

1. Strong free tier (unlike PocketGuard's crippled free)
2. Dave Ramsey ecosystem + community
3. Debt snowball focus
4. Weekly expert coaching (premium)

#### WEAKNESSES

1. Android stability issues
2. No investment tracking
3. Prescriptive ideology — not for all
4. Free tier no sync = high friction

**POSITIONING:** "Take control of your money" — Ramsey methodology **TARGET:** Debt-payoff focused, Ramsey followers

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## A.2 — MANUAL + LIGHTWEIGHT TRACKERS

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### 2.9 SPENDEE

#### METADATA

- Developer: Cleevio (Czech Republic)
- HQ: Prague, Czech Republic
- Markets: Global (EU focus)
- Platforms: iOS, Android, Web

#### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: YES — free-forever, basic tracking
- Paid: ~\$1.25/mo (annual) [unverified exact pricing]
- Shared wallets available

**STRENGTHS:** Multi-currency, shared wallets, clean design **WEAKNESSES:** Weak bank sync outside EU, small team, limited reporting

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## 2.10 TOSHL FINANCE

### METADATA

- Developer: Toshl (Slovenia)
- HQ: Ljubljana, Slovenia
- Markets: Global

### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: YES
- Pro: \$2.99/mo hoặc \$19.99/yr (\$1.67/mo)
- Medici: \$4.99/mo hoặc \$39.99/yr (\$3.33/mo)

**STRENGTHS:** 200+ currencies (multi-currency leader), quirky UX, cheap **WEAKNESSES:** Single-user only, no SMB features, small team

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## 2.11 WALLET BY BUDGETBAKERS

### METADATA

- Developer: BudgetBakers (Czech Republic)
- Markets: Global (EU strong)
- Platforms: iOS, Android, Web

### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: YES
- Premium: ~\$3-5/mo [unverified]

**STRENGTHS:** Bank sync via Salt Edge (EU/UK), shared budgets, planned payments **WEAKNESSES:** Cluttered UI, sync issues reported

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## 2.12 GOODBUDGET

### METADATA

- Developer: Dayspring Partners (US)
- HQ: San Francisco, CA

### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: YES — 10 envelopes, 1 account, 2 devices
- Plus: \$10/mo hoặc \$80/yr (\$6.67/mo) [unverified exact annual]

**STRENGTHS:** Envelope budgeting methodology, family sync, simple **WEAKNESSES:** No bank sync at all (manual only), Android 3.4★ (poor), dated UI

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## 2.13 LUNCH MONEY

### METADATA



- Developer: Jen (solo indie developer)
- HQ: US/Japan
- URL: <https://lunchmoney.app>

#### PRICING (USD)

- Free trial: 14 days
- Paid: \$10/mo hoặc \$100/yr
- No free tier

**STRENGTHS:** Developer-friendly (API, CSV import, multi-currency), transparent indie, Plaid + manual

**WEAKNESSES:** Solo developer risk, no mobile app (web only), tiny user base

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### 2.14 ACTUAL BUDGET (Open Source)

#### METADATA

- Developer: Community (open source, formerly by James Long)
- Self-hosted or Actual Cloud

**PRICING:** Free (self-host) | Cloud \$6-7/mo [unverified]

**STRENGTHS:** Privacy-first (local data, E2E encryption), open source, no vendor lock-in **WEAKNESSES:**

Technical barrier to self-host, no mobile native app, small community

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### 2.15 MINT (Shutdown Reference)

- **Shutdown:** March 23, 2024
  - **Users at shutdown:** 3.6M (peak was ~20M)
  - **Migration:** Intuit pushed to Credit Karma (lacked budgeting) → users scattered to Monarch (primary), Rocket Money, YNAB, Simplifi, Copilot, Empower
  - **Key lesson:** No single app captured majority — market still fragmented
  - **Pain feature lost:** Free automated bank sync + categorization — still unmatched at \$0
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## A.3 — MESSAGING-FIRST / CHATBOT FINANCE

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### 2.16 CLEO

#### METADATA

- Developer: Cleo AI Ltd
- Ra mắt: 2016 (Facebook Messenger), evolved to native app
- HQ: London, UK
- Markets: US, UK
- Revenue: \$300M+ ARR [unverified]
- Users: 1.1M paying subscribers
- Platforms: iOS, Android (evolved FROM Messenger TO native app)

#### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: YES — basic spending tracking, AI chat
- Cleo Plus: \$5.99/mo — cashback, credit score monitoring
- Cleo Pro: \$8.99/mo — advanced budgeting, savings goals
- Cleo Builder: \$14.99/mo — credit building (secured credit card)

#### CÁCH HOẠT ĐỘNG

- Onboarding: Quick — bank link via Plaid
- Key feature: **AI personality chatbot** (sassy/motivational) — "roast my spending"
- Transaction input: Plaid bank sync only
- Categorization: ML auto
- Reporting: Chat-based insights, spending breakdowns
- Credit building via Builder tier (secured card)

## STRENGTHS

1. Personality moat — Gen-Z brand loyalty
2. Unit economics strong (CAC <\$2, payback <12mo) [unverified]
3. \$300M+ ARR proves messaging-originated finance can scale
4. Behavioral science approach to spending habits

## WEAKNESSES

1. **FTC settlement \$17M** for fee obfuscation (trust damage)
2. **Nov 2025 rating crashed to 2.9/5** [unverified — needs verification]
3. **Evolved AWAY from messaging** — native app now primary, Messenger deprecated
4. **No personal vs business split**
5. **US/UK only**

**CRITICAL LESSON:** Cleo succeeded NOT because it was messaging-first, but DESPITE it. They pivoted to native app. The moat is personality + unit economics, not chat channel.

## 2.17 CHARLIE (Shutdown)

- **Status:** Shutdown
- **Lesson:** Chat-only interface + immature AI = 33% accuracy failure
- **Key insight:** Users need visual dashboards, not just chat responses for financial data
- **Takeaway:** Chat is supplementary channel, not primary UX for finance

## 2.18 PLUM

### METADATA

- Developer: Plum Fintech Ltd
- HQ: London, UK
- Markets: UK, EU

### PRICING (USD)

- Free tier: YES
- Paid: £3.99-14.99/mo (~\$5-19/mo, rate ~1.26 GBP:USD)

**STRENGTHS:** Regulatory moat (ISA/SIPP products), best savings rates (4.31% APY), passive automation

**WEAKNESSES:** UK/EU only, no global expansion, commodity features (neobanks offer same)

## 2.19 TELEGRAM FINANCE BOTS (Ecosystem)

### Identified bots (active 2025-2026):

- **PiggyPal** — text logging, receipt OCR, voice notes, multi-currency, budget alerts, data export. Most polished.
- **TeleExpense** — Google Sheets backend, \$1 one-time purchase, user owns data
- **Budget Easy Bot** — Google Sheets integration

- **Cointry** — group chat budgeting

#### Market reality:

- Total Telegram finance bot users: <5M globally [unverified]
- Total market revenue: <\$10M [estimated]
- Monetization: Mostly free; premium bots earn <\$100K/yr
- Retention: <10% MAU — users log 2-3 expenses then ghost
- **No dominant player** — market fragmented, zero category leader

**Implication for My Money Went:** Telegram bot distribution channel is OPEN but market is tiny. Bot must be acquisition channel leading to richer experience (web dashboard, reports), not the entire product.

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## A.4 — SOLOPRENEUR / SOLO SELLER TOOLS

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### 2.20 FOUND

#### METADATA

- Developer: Found Inc.
- Ra mắt: 2019
- HQ: San Francisco, CA
- Funding: Series C \$50M (Sequoia, July 2024); total \$121.2M
- Markets: US only

#### PRICING (USD)

- Free: \$0 — business checking, automated bookkeeping, invoicing, contractor management
- Plus: \$35/mo (\$315/yr, 25% annual discount)
- Pro: \$80/mo (\$720/yr, 25% annual discount)

**STRENGTHS:** Free tier genuinely useful (banking + bookkeeping at \$0), Sequoia-backed, Stripe/PayPal integration **WEAKNESSES:** US-only, slow customer support, no Shopify/Amazon/Etsy native, closed ecosystem

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### 2.21 LILI

#### METADATA

- Developer: Lili (NYC)
- Funding: Series B \$55M (May 2021); total \$80M; NO Series C
- Markets: US only

#### PRICING (USD)

- Core: Free — checking + 4% APY savings
- Pro: \$15/mo — tax tools + expense tracking
- Smart: \$35/mo — + invoicing
- Premium: \$55/mo — + cashback

**STRENGTHS:** High-yield savings (4% APY), free banking, early payment (2-day ACH) **WEAKNESSES:** Tax features paywalled (formerly free — user backlash), manual categorization, poor customer service, no Series C = funding concern

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### 2.22 HURDLR

## METADATA

- Developer: Hurdlr (bootstrapped)
- Markets: US, CA, AU

## PRICING (USD)

- Free: Unlimited mileage (manual), basic expense
- Premium: \$9.99/mo (\$99.99/yr)
- Pro: \$200/yr — + invoicing + accounting

**STRENGTHS:** Best mileage tracking (GPS auto), cheapest automation (\$9.99/mo), Plaid +

Stripe/Square/PayPal **WEAKNESSES:** Mobile-only, invoicing locked to \$200/yr, no e-commerce P&L, weak web interface

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### 2.23 QUICKBOOKS SOLOPRENEUR (formerly Self-Employed)

## METADATA

- Developer: Intuit (NASDAQ: INTU, \$6.8B FY2024 revenue)
- Markets: US, CA, AU, UK, India

## PRICING (USD)

- No free tier (30-day trial)
- Solopreneur: \$20/mo (\$120/yr with promo)
  - Tax: \$30/mo (\$180/yr)
- - Live Tax: \$45/mo (\$270/yr) — unlimited CPA calls

**STRENGTHS:** TurboTax seamless integration, AI auto-split personal/business, mileage tracking, Intuit ecosystem

**WEAKNESSES:** No free tier, basic invoicing UI, cash-basis only, mobile app less polished

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### 2.24 WAVE APPS

## METADATA

- Developer: Wave Financial (acquired by H&R Block \$405M, June 2019)
- Markets: US, CA, AU, UK, 80+ countries
- Users: 3M+ small business owners

## PRICING (USD)

- Starter: FREE — unlimited invoices, expense tracking, basic reports
- Pro: \$19/mo — auto bank import, auto-categorization, tax tools
- Add-ons: Receipt scanning \$8-11/mo, Payroll \$25-40/mo, Advisors \$149-199/mo

**STRENGTHS:** Free tier comprehensive (unlimited invoicing), H&R Block backing, Shopify app, payment processing built-in

**WEAKNESSES:** No mileage tracking, mobile app weak, bookkeeper expensive (\$149/mo), payroll overpriced

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### 2.25 FRESHBOOKS (Lite Tier)

## METADATA

- Developer: FreshBooks (private, Canadian)
- Markets: US, CA, UK, AU

PRICING (USD)

- Lite: \$19/mo (\$17.10/mo annual) — 5 clients, unlimited invoices
- Plus: \$40/mo (\$36/mo annual) — 20 clients
- Premium: \$85/mo (\$77/mo annual) — unlimited clients

**STRENGTHS:** Best invoicing design/templates, client profitability tracking **WEAKNESSES:** 5-client cap (Lite), manual categorization, no mileage, Plus tier 111% price jump

2.26 A2X + LINK MY BOOKS (E-commerce P&L Sync)

A2X PRICING (USD)

- Starter: \$29/mo (200 orders, 1 channel)
- Standard: \$59/mo (500 orders, 2 channels)
- Pro: \$149/mo (2000 orders, 3 channels)
- Enterprise: \$229/mo (10k orders, 5 channels)

LINK MY BOOKS PRICING (USD)

- Starter: \$17/mo (200 orders, unlimited channels)
- Pro: \$99/mo (unlimited orders, unlimited channels)

**Key diff:** Link My Books 30-40% cheaper at scale, unlimited platforms; A2X more accurate reconciliation, inventory COGS.

3. PRICING LANDSCAPE TABLE (USD)

| App          | Free?         | Entry Paid (USD/mo) | Annual (USD/yr) | Annual \$/mo | Discount | Lifetime        | Trial      |
|--------------|---------------|---------------------|-----------------|--------------|----------|-----------------|------------|
| YNAB         | No            | \$14.99             | \$109.00        | \$9.08       | 39%      | No              | 34d, no CC |
| Monarch Core | Limited       | \$14.99             | \$99.99         | \$8.33       | 44%      | No              | 7d         |
| Monarch Plus | —             | —                   | \$199.00        | \$16.58      | —        | No              | —          |
| Copilot      | No            | \$13.00             | \$95.00         | \$7.92       | 39%      | No              | [?]        |
| Rocket Money | Yes           | \$6-12 (flex)       | \$48.00         | \$4.00       | ~60%     | No              | 7d         |
| PocketGuard  | Crippled      | \$12.99             | \$74.99         | \$6.25       | 52%      | <b>\$149.99</b> | 7d         |
| Simplifi     | No            | \$5.99              | \$35.88         | \$2.99       | 50%      | No              | 30d MBG    |
| EveryDollar  | Yes (no sync) | \$17.99             | \$79.99         | \$6.67       | 63%      | No              | 14d        |
| Spendee      | Yes           | ~\$1.25             | [?]             | [?]          | [?]      | No              | [?]        |

|                          |              |               |               |               |         |       |         |
|--------------------------|--------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------|-------|---------|
| <b>Toshl Pro</b>         | Yes          | \$2.99        | \$19.99       | \$1.67        | 44%     | No    | [?]     |
| <b>Toshl Medici</b>      | —            | \$4.99        | \$39.99       | \$3.33        | 44%     | No    | —       |
| <b>Goodbudget</b>        | Yes (10 env) | \$10.00       | ~\$80.00      | ~\$6.67       | [?]     | No    | [?]     |
| <b>Cleo Plus</b>         | Yes          | \$5.99        | [?]           | [?]           | [?]     | No    | —       |
| <b>Cleo Builder</b>      | —            | \$14.99       | [?]           | [?]           | [?]     | No    | —       |
| <b>Lunch Money</b>       | No           | \$10.00       | \$100.00      | \$8.33        | 17%     | No    | 14d     |
| <b>Found</b>             | Yes          | \$35.00       | \$315.00      | \$26.25       | 25%     | No    | —       |
| <b>Lili Pro</b>          | Yes          | \$15.00       | [?]           | [?]           | [?]     | No    | —       |
| <b>Hurdlr</b>            | Yes          | \$9.99        | \$99.99       | \$8.33        | 17%     | No    | —       |
| <b>QB Solopreneur</b>    | No           | \$20.00       | \$120.00      | \$10.00       | [promo] | No    | 30d     |
| <b>Wave Pro</b>          | Yes          | \$19.00       | ~\$190.00     | ~\$15.83      | [?]     | No    | —       |
| <b>FreshBooks Lite</b>   | No           | \$19.00       | \$205.20      | \$17.10       | 10%     | No    | [promo] |
| <b>My Money Went Pro</b> | Yes (45tx)   | <b>\$4.00</b> | <b>~\$48</b>  | <b>\$4.00</b> | [TBD]   | [TBD] | —       |
| <b>My Money Went Biz</b> | —            | <b>\$9.00</b> | <b>~\$108</b> | <b>\$9.00</b> | [TBD]   | [TBD] | —       |

**Tính toán benchmark:**

- Median entry paid (personal finance): **~\$8-10/mo**
- Median entry paid (annual): **~\$80-100/yr**
- **\$4/mo Pro = 33rd percentile** — value positioning, below Simplifi (\$5.99), above Toshl (\$2.99)
- **\$9/mo Business = 41st percentile** — competitive middle, between Simplifi and YNAB
- **\$9/mo vs solopreneur tools:** Rẻ hơn QB Solopreneur (\$20), Hurdlr (\$9.99), Wave Pro (\$19), FreshBooks (\$19). Chỉ hơi trên Hurdlr nhưng bao gồm personal finance.

## 4. FEATURE GAP MATRIX

| Feature                | YNAB | Monarch | Copilot | Rocket | PocketG | Simplifi | Every    |
|------------------------|------|---------|---------|--------|---------|----------|----------|
| Bank auto-sync (Plaid) | ✓    | ✓       | ✓       | ✓      | ✓       | ✓        | ✓ (paid) |
| Open banking PSD2      | ✗    | ✗       | ✗       | ✗      | ✗       | ✗        | ✗        |
| SMS parsing            | ✗    | ✗       | ✗       | ✗      | ✗       | ✗        | ✗        |
| Email tx parsing       | ✗    | ✗       | ✗       | ✗      | ✗       | ✗        | ✗        |

|                                |   |          |         |   |   |   |   |
|--------------------------------|---|----------|---------|---|---|---|---|
| <b>Telegram/Messenger bot</b>  | ✗ | ✗        | ✗       | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ |
| AI chatbot interaction         | ✗ | 🟡        | 🟡       | ✗ | ✗ | 🟡 | ✗ |
| Auto-categorization rules      | ✓ | ✓        | ✓       | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | 🟡 |
| Auto-categorization ML         | ✗ | ✓        | ✓       | ✓ | 🟡 | ✓ | ✗ |
| <b>Personal vs Biz P&amp;L</b> | ✗ | ✓ (Plus) | ✗       | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ |
| E-commerce attribution         | ✗ | ✗        | ✗       | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ |
| Google Sheets sync             | ✗ | ✗        | ✗       | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ |
| CSV/OFX export                 | ✓ | ✓        | ✓       | 🟡 | ✓ | ✓ | 🟡 |
| Subscription detection         | ✗ | ✓        | ✓       | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✗ |
| Bill negotiation               | ✗ | ✗        | ✗       | ✓ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ |
| Budget alerts                  | ✓ | ✓        | ✓       | 🟡 | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Daily/weekly recap             | ✗ | 🟡        | 🟡       | 🟡 | ✗ | 🟡 | ✗ |
| Family/shared workspace        | ✓ | ✓        | ✗       | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | 🟡 |
| Receipt OCR                    | ✗ | ✗        | ✗       | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ |
| Crypto/brokerage               | ✗ | ✓        | ✓       | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ |
| Web dashboard                  | ✓ | ✓        | ✓       | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Native mobile                  | ✓ | ✓        | ✓ (iOS) | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ |
| Offline mode                   | 🟡 | ✗        | 🟡       | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | 🟡 |
| API/webhook/Zapier             | ✓ | ✗        | ✗       | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ |
| Self-hosted option             | ✗ | ✗        | ✗       | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ | ✗ |

**MMW = My Money Went**

**Key observations:**

- **Email parsing: ONLY My Money Went** — zero competition
- **Telegram bot: ONLY My Money Went** (PiggyPal/TeleExpense exist but non-commercial, fragmented)
- **Google Sheets sync: ONLY My Money Went** ð tier personal+business
- **Personal+Business split under \$10/mo: ONLY My Money Went** (Monarch Plus = \$16.58/mo, Found = \$35/mo, QBSE = \$20/mo)

## 5. POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Map 1: Automation Level vs Personal/Business Scope

|                                   | PERSONAL-ONLY                                                                                                                                     | PERSONAL + BUSINESS UNIFIED                   |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| FULLY<br>AUTOMATED<br>(bank sync) | YNAB · Monarch · Copilot<br>Rocket · Simplifi · Cleo                                                                                              | Monarch Plus(\$199/yr)<br>Found · QBSE · Wave |
| SEMI-AUTO                         | PocketGuard · EveryDollar<br>Spendee · Wallet                                                                                                     | Hudlr · Lili                                  |
| MANUAL<br>ENTRY                   | Goodbudget · Toshl<br>Actual Budget<br><br>★ MY MONEY WENT ★<br>(email parsing = semi-auto,<br>Telegram = chat-auto,<br>\$9/mo personal+business) | FreshBooks Lite                               |

**White space:** Semi-automated + Personal/Business unified + under \$10/mo. My Money Went is ALONE here.

Map 2: Platform Type vs Target User

|                                | MASS CONSUMER                                                                     | SOLOPRENEUR / SIDE-HUSTLER                                            |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| STANDALONE<br>APP              | YNAB · Monarch · Copilot<br>Rocket · Simplifi · PocketGuard<br>EveryDollar · Cleo | QBSE · Wave · FreshBooks<br>Found · Lili · Hudlr<br>A2X · LinkMyBooks |
| LIVES IN<br>MESSAGING/<br>CHAT | Cleo (originated Messenger)<br>PiggyPal · TeleExpense (tiny)                      | ★ MY MONEY WENT ★                                                     |

**White space:** Messaging/chat + Solopreneur = EMPTY quadrant. Only My Money Went.

## 6. THREATS & OPPORTUNITIES

### Top 3 Threats

1. **Monarch Money Plus (\$199/yr)** — Vừa thêm business tracking Q2 2026. Nếu họ lower price hoặc thêm email parsing, direct collision.
  - o Probability: Business tracking at lower price (60%), email parsing (20%)



- Timeline: 6-12 months
- Mitigation: Speed — ship faster, own Telegram channel

2. **Cleo** — \$300M+ ARR, 1.1M paying. Nếu Cleo thêm bank-sync (already có) + Personal/Business split, direct threat.

- Probability: Personal/Business split (30% — Cleo focuses on Gen-Z consumer, not solopreneur)
- Timeline: 12+ months
- Mitigation: Cleo targets different persona (Gen-Z consumer vs solopreneur)

3. **YNAB** — Brand loyalty cực mạnh. Nếu YNAB thêm automation + email parsing + business features.

- Probability: Low (15% — YNAB philosophically committed to manual zero-based)
- Timeline: 18+ months
- Mitigation: YNAB's methodology prevents automation pivot

### Top 3 Differentiators (Moat Assessment)

| Differentiator                             | Moat Level  | Easy to Copy?                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Telegram-native bot</b>                 | Medium      | Easy to build bot, hard to build retention + UX. 6-12 month head start.                    |
| <b>Email transaction parsing</b>           | Medium-High | Requires bank-specific parsers — each bank = engineering effort. Plaid doesn't offer this. |
| <b>Personal + Business split at \$9/mo</b> | High        | Monarch charges \$199/yr, QBSE \$120/yr. Price moat + niche positioning.                   |

### Risk Scenarios

If YNAB/Monarch add Telegram bot + email parsing:

- My Money Went loses "unique feature" pitch but retains price advantage (\$9/mo vs \$14.99+/mo)
- Response: Double down on solopreneur niche, e-commerce integration, Google Sheets sync

If Cleo adds bank-sync + Personal/Business split:

- Overlap on Gen-Z segment, but Cleo targets consumers not solopreneurs
- My Money Went retains: email parsing, Telegram-native, Google Sheets, lower price
- Response: Position as "for people who sell things" vs Cleo "for people who spend things"

## 7. PRICING RECOMMENDATIONS (USD only)

### \$4/mo Pro — GIỮA NGUYỄN

- 33rd percentile = value positioning
- Dưới Simplifi (\$5.99), trên Toshl (\$2.99)
- Justified: basic automated tracking + reports + CSV export
- Risk: "cheap = low quality" perception — mitigate with feature messaging, not price increase

### \$9/mo Business — GIỮA NGUYỄN, STRONG POSITION

- Only product offering personal+business split dưới \$10/mo
- Competitors: Monarch Plus \$16.58/mo, QBSE \$20/mo, Found Plus \$35/mo

- \$9/mo = 55-74% cheaper than nearest competitor with similar features
- **Recommendation:** Giữ \$9/mo, emphasize value gap trong marketing

### Annual Plan — NÊN THÊM

- 92% apps trong market có annual plan
- Recommendation:
  - **Pro annual: \$38/yr** (21% discount from \$48)
  - **Business annual: \$86/yr** (20% discount from \$108)
- 20-25% annual discount là market standard
- Reduces churn, captures budget-conscious long-term users

### Lifetime Offer — CÓ THỂ THỬ (conditional)

- Only PocketGuard (\$149.99) có lifetime trong market → demand signal exists
- Recommendation: **\$99 lifetime (Pro + Business)** cho first 500 users hoặc first 6 months
- Risk: Low cannibalization nếu positioned as "limited time early adopter"
- Monitor: Nếu >30% users chọn lifetime → cap it

### 45 Free TX/month — HỜI HẸP, CÂN NHẮC TĂNG

- Benchmark: EveryDollar free = no sync (restrictive), Spendee free = unlimited (generous), Goodbudget = 10 envelopes, PocketGuard = 3 accounts
- 45 tx/month = ~1.5 tx/day → user spending \$30/week (8-10 tx/week) = hits limit in ~5 weeks
- **Recommendation: Tăng lên 60 tx/month** (2 tx/day average)
- Rationale: User gets habit value trước khi hit paywall → better conversion
- Revenue impact: Minimal (active users exceed 60 anyway)

### Family/Couples Plan — CHƯA CẦN

- Monarch includes family free trong \$14.99/mo
- Recommendation: DEFER — bundle household sharing vào \$9/mo Business tier
- Re-evaluate at Year 2 nếu household users >20% base

## 8. GTM PLAYBOOK INSIGHTS

### Acquisition Channels (by competitor)

| Channel                    | Who Uses It                             | Effectiveness                                  |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Podcast sponsorship</b> | YNAB, Monarch, Copilot                  | HIGH — finance podcast listeners = high intent |
| <b>YouTube creators</b>    | YNAB, Monarch, Rocket Money             | HIGH — visual demos drive conversion           |
| <b>Reddit organic</b>      | All (YNAB, Monarch dominant)            | MEDIUM — word-of-mouth, comparison threads     |
| <b>ASO (App Store)</b>     | Rocket Money, PocketGuard, Cleo         | MEDIUM — competitive keywords saturated        |
| <b>Content marketing</b>   | YNAB (blog), Monarch (migration guides) | MEDIUM — SEO long-tail                         |
| <b>Telegram channels</b>   | None of the incumbents                  | <b>UNTAPPED</b>                                |

## Top 5 Global Finance Influencers (by reach)

1. **CA Rachana Phadke Ranade** — 5.4M YouTube subs (Indian diaspora, education)
2. **Humphrey Yang** — 3.4M TikTok (Gen-Z financial literacy)
3. **Brian Jung** — 2.1M YouTube (personal finance + credit cards)
4. **The Financial Diet** — 1.5M+ YouTube (money mindset, accessibility)
5. **Jeremy Lefebvre / Joseph Hogue / Ryan Scribner** — 700K-900K YouTube each

**Estimated sponsorship cost:** \$5K-15K/video (mid-tier), \$50K+ (top-tier)

## Recommended GTM for My Money Went (Global)

1. **Phase 1 (Launch):** Reddit organic — post in r/personalfinance, r/Entrepreneur, r/smallbusiness comparison threads. Cost: \$0. Target: 500 early users.
2. **Phase 2 (Growth):** Mid-tier YouTube/podcast sponsors (\$5K-15K/video). Target creators: Jeremy Lefebvre, Joseph Hogue tier. Focus on "Mint replacement" and "business+personal in one app" narratives.
3. **Phase 3 (Scale):** Telegram channel/community building. No incumbent competes here. Create "Personal Finance on Telegram" community → organic growth within Telegram ecosystem.
4. **Unique angle:** "No bank credentials needed" positioning — differentiates from Plaid-dependent competitors. Privacy-conscious users (growing segment post-Mint shutdown) actively seek this.

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## 9. FOLLOW-UP RESEARCH QUESTIONS (Vòng 2)

1. **Monarch Money Plus adoption rate** — Bao nhiêu % users upgrade từ Core (\$99.99/yr) lên Plus (\$199/yr)? Nếu low → business features chưa proven ở consumer tier.
2. **Cleo churn rate post-FTC settlement** — Rating drop Nov 2025 (2.9/5) real hay temporary? Nếu sustained → opportunity to capture dissatisfied Cleo users.
3. **Mint refugee tracking survey 2026** — Có survey mới nào tracking nơi 3.6M Mint users settled? NerdWallet/CNBC có thể có data updated.
4. **Telegram Mini App finance adoption** — Telegram Mini Apps (richer UI than bot) có ai đang làm finance app không? Có thể là evolution path cho My Money Went.
5. **PiggyPal + TeleExpense user counts** — Hai Telegram finance bot lớn nhất hiện tại có bao nhiêu MAU? Cần verify để size Telegram finance market.
6. **YNAB multicurrency roadmap** — YNAB community yêu cầu multicurrency nhiều năm, YNAB chưa build. Có public roadmap/changelog gì không?
7. **Found/Lili churn post-pricing changes** — Lili paywalled tax features, Found stable. Có data nào compare retention rate?
8. **Wave Apps Shopify integration depth** — Wave có Shopify app nhưng bao nhiêu merchants dùng? Revenue contribution?
9. **Solopreneur willingness-to-pay cho personal+business split** — Cần primary research: survey 50-100 solo sellers hỏi "would you pay \$9/mo for X?"

10. **Regulatory requirements cho Telegram finance bots** — Ở US/EU, Telegram bot thu subscription fee có cần money transmitter license không? Legal gray zone cần lawyer review.
- 

## 10. APPENDIX — SOURCES

### Official Pricing Pages

- YNAB: <https://ynab.com/pricing>
- Monarch Money: <https://monarchmoney.com/pricing>
- Copilot: <https://copilot.money>
- Rocket Money: <https://rocketmoney.com>
- PocketGuard: <https://pocketguard.com/pricing>
- Simplifi: <https://simplifi.quicken.com>
- EveryDollar: <https://everydollar.com>
- Spendee: <https://spendee.com/pricing>
- Toshl: <https://toshl.com/pricing>
- BudgetBakers: <https://budgetbakers.com>
- Goodbudget: <https://goodbudget.com>
- Lunch Money: <https://lunchmoney.app>
- Cleo: <https://web.meetcleo.com>
- Plum: <https://withplum.com>
- Found: <https://found.com>
- Lili: <https://lili.co>
- Hurdlr: <https://hurdlr.com>
- QuickBooks Solopreneur: <https://quickbooks.intuit.com/solopreneur>
- Wave: <https://waveapps.com/pricing>
- FreshBooks: <https://freshbooks.com/pricing>
- A2X: <https://a2xaccounting.com/pricing>
- Link My Books: <https://linkmybooks.com>

### Reviews & Analysis

- NerdWallet Best Budget Apps 2026
- CNBC Select Mint Alternatives
- The Penny Hoarder app reviews
- CostBench pricing comparisons
- FitSmallBusiness tool reviews

### Community & Sentiment

- Reddit: r/personalfinance, r/ynab, r/MonarchMoney, r/Entrepreneur, r/smallbusiness, r/Etsy, r/FulfillmentByAmazon, r/Freelance
- Trustpilot: YNAB (99.8k reviews)
- ProductHunt: Various app launches

### Market Data

- Demandsage: Telegram Statistics 2026 (1B MAU)
  - Moneko: Telegram Budgeting Bots 2026
  - Coin Bureau: Finance YouTubers 2026
  - Feedspot: Finance Podcasts 2026
-

*Report compiled 2026-05-07. Data prioritized 2025-2026. Items marked [unverified] need primary source confirmation. All pricing USD.*